Tutorial 5

Prepare a test plan and an online questionnaire

Test scenario

You are working as a UX researcher and you have been assigned to conduct usability testing for Snapfish.

https://www.snapfish.co.uk/home

A large number of Snapfish clients are parents. To retain and expand on this type of clientele (which is responsible for considerable profits), Snapfish has asked you to conduct a study with users and find out about the ease of use of the feature of their website to create a bespoke photo book.

Work in pairs or in groups of a maximum 3 people and explore for 5-10 minutes Snapfish. Identify a couple of tasks you would like to investigate to address usability issues. Before you organise a study you need to have a clear understanding of the tasks you want to study related to user behaviour and preference. For example:

- if it provides the required tools to complete tasks (e.g. to create a photobook);
- if the design of the application conveys the available functionality (to create a photo book, to upload images, etc.);
- if it provides enough tools to modify layouts/templates/designs;
- the average time it takes to complete specific tasks;
- is there enough help provided to overcome difficulties;
- if there is there enough documentation;
- how users feel about the overall usability of the website.

You need to collect performance and preference data related to the main user experience metrics.

Organise your study around a scenario where you ask the participants to create a 8X8 inches bespoke photo book album with a birthday theme. They need to include at least 10 pictures and design the cover page, the back page, and a few pages inside the photo book (at least 6). Each page of the photo book should have a different style. The photo book layout should be suitable for the pictures to be included. Ask the participants to use short descriptive text on the photo book pages (in each picture or a group of pictures per page). Ask them to customize the cover page, the background colour of the photo book pages, borders, and embellishments.

Plan your test for an **online**, **unmoderated** usability testing session.

Task 1. As a group complete all of the following tasks:

- Form a couple of research questions around which you will form your study;

- Form each research question with a couple of hypotheses to serve descriptive, experimental and correlational research;
- Define the dependent and independent variables for each hypothesis you are evaluating;
- Express the hypotheses you formed mathematically.
- Identify what data you need to collect to evaluate your hypotheses.

Tips on Research Questions – What are we trying to find out based on the specific study?

1) What is the average time participants took to complete a specific task? (Descriptive)
2) Does having previously uploaded pictures on the site affect the average time required to complete a photobook? (Experimental)
3) Does prior experience in creating a photobook affect the average time required to complete a photobook? (Correlational)

Task 2. Once you have identified what data you need to collect to evaluate your hypotheses create a task that outlines the steps of the study (**session script**). This should outline what you expect the users to do and what data you will be collecting to evaluate the hypotheses you have formed.

The test plan (session script) should include the following information:

- The characteristics of the participants to take part at the study and how many you will recruit
- How will you split your groups (will it be within or between study?)
- A task plan to guide the users on the tasks they will have to complete
- The result that the participant will strive to achieve (refer to actual data and names rather than generalities)
- What data will you collect for each task and how will you be collecting it (you will observe the users and do not taking, you will ask a question)
- The state of the system when the task is initiated
- Readouts of displays and printouts that the participants will see while performing the task

Have a look at the example of the **session script** on Blackboard.

Task 3. For all the questions you will use to collect data create the respective:

- **pre-test**,
- **in-test,** and
- **post-test questionnaire**

Use **Microsoft 365 Forms** to turn those questions into a form that you can distribute to users to collect data that will help you to evaluate your research question. Make sure you give the right permissions to the form for the users to complete it.

After the completion of the **Microsoft 365 Form** create a spreadsheet that will be collecting the data. You will need this to analyse the data in the following tutorials.

Each group should form at least **2 pre-test**, **6 in-test,** and **2 post-test questions**.

Task 4. After you have completed your Task plan and questionnaire share it, to allow users to complete the task and provide you with the required data.

Task 5. Access the Ethics forms that need to be completed before you conduct a study involving participants at the University of Westminster available on Blackboard. Look at a completed example. How those forms will be modified for your study?

Task 6. Experiment with a tool like https://lookback.io/ Maze/UserTesting/Useberry which is designed for online usability testing sessions, create a session for your users, share the link to participants, record a session with them and playback your recording. Perhaps you could consider this tool to collect data for your Coursework or use **Microsoft Teams** that allows to record a session and keep a transcript of a session.